

# Secrets

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## Background

Secrets are a type of binding that allow you to attach encrypted text values to your Worker. You cannot see secrets after you set them and can only access secrets via [Wrangler](#) or programmatically via the [env parameter](#). Secrets are used for storing sensitive information like API keys and auth tokens. Secrets are available on the [env parameter](#) passed to your Worker's [fetch event handler](#).

### Secrets Store (beta)

Secrets described on this page are defined and managed on a per-Worker level. If you want to use account-level secrets, refer to [Secrets Store](#). Account-level secrets are configured on your Worker as a [Secrets Store binding](#).

## Local Development with Secrets

When developing your Worker or Pages Function, create a `.dev.vars` file in the root of your project to define secrets that will be used when running `wrangler dev` or `wrangler pages dev`, as opposed to using environment variables in the [Wrangler configuration file](#). This works both in local and remote development modes.

The `.dev.vars` file should be formatted like a `dotenv` file, such as `KEY="VALUE"`:

```
.dev.vars
```

```
SECRET_KEY="value"  
API_TOKEN="eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9"
```

To set different secrets for each environment, create files named `.dev.vars.<environment-name>`. When you use `wrangler <command> --env <environment-name>`, the corresponding environment-specific file will be loaded instead of the `.dev.vars` file.

Like other environment variables, secrets are [non-inheritable](#) and must be defined per environment.

## Secrets on deployed Workers

### Adding secrets to your project

#### Via Wrangler

Secrets can be added through [wrangler secret put](#) or [wrangler versions secret put](#) commands.

`wrangler secret put` creates a new version of the Worker and deploys it immediately.

```
npx wrangler secret put <KEY>
```

If using [gradual deployments](#), instead use the `wrangler versions secret put` command. This will only create a new version of the Worker, that can then be deploying using [wrangler versions deploy](#).

#### Note

Wrangler versions before 3.73.0 require you to specify a `--x-versions` flag.

```
npx wrangler versions secret put <KEY>
```

## Via the dashboard

To add a secret via the dashboard:

1. Log in to [Cloudflare dashboard](#) and select your account.
2. Select **Workers & Pages**.
3. In **Overview**, select your Worker > **Settings**.
4. Under **Variables and Secrets**, select **Add**.
5. Select the type **Secret**, input a **Variable name**, and input its **Value**. This secret will be made available to your Worker but the value will be hidden in Wrangler and the dashboard.
6. (Optional) To add more secrets, select **Add variable**.
7. Select **Deploy** to implement your changes.

## Delete secrets from your project

### Via Wrangler

Secrets can be deleted through [wrangler secret delete](#) or [wrangler versions secret delete](#) commands.

`wrangler secret delete` creates a new version of the Worker and deploys it immediately.

```
npx wrangler secret delete <KEY>
```

If using [gradual deployments](#), instead use the `wrangler versions secret delete` command. This will only create a new version of the Worker, that can then be deploying using [wrangler versions deploy](#).

```
npx wrangler versions secret delete <KEY>
```

### Via the dashboard

To delete a secret from your Worker project via the dashboard:

1. Log in to [Cloudflare dashboard](#) and select your account.
2. Select **Workers & Pages**.
3. In **Overview**, select your Worker > **Settings**.
4. Under **Variables and Secrets**, select **Edit**.
5. In the **Edit** drawer, select **X** next to the secret you want to delete.
6. Select **Deploy** to implement your changes.
7. (Optional) Instead of using the edit drawer, you can click the delete icon next to the secret.

## Compare secrets and environment variables

### Use secrets for sensitive information

Do not use plaintext environment variables to store sensitive information. Use [secrets](#) or [Secrets Store bindings](#) instead.

[Secrets](#) are [environment variables](#). The difference is secret values are not visible within Wrangler or Cloudflare dashboard after you define them. This means that sensitive data, including passwords or API tokens, should always be encrypted to prevent data leaks. To your Worker, there is no difference between an environment variable and a secret. The secret's value is passed through as defined.

## Related resources

- [Wrangler secret commands](#) - Review the Wrangler commands to create, delete and list secrets.
- [Cloudflare Secrets Store](#) - Encrypt and store sensitive information as secrets that are securely reusable across your account.

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